

Creating Your Customer Avatar

One of the most important exercises you can do to create a successful marketing strategy and successful marketing communications is to develop a “character” or mental image that represents the “average” of all of your prospective customers. I call this character your “Customer Avatar.” By creating a Customer Avatar, you can then imagine what it would be like to experience life as that person - which gives you the opportunity to “walk in their shoes” - and also allows you to discover their fears, frustrations, wants, aspirations and “emotional hot buttons.” Begin by answering the following questions...

- 1. What are the “demographic” commonalities of your ideal customers? Are more of them male or female? How old are they? What kinds of jobs do they have? How much money do they make?**
- 2. What are the “psychographic” commonalities of your ideal customers? What are their fears and frustrations in life? What are their desires and aspirations?**
- 3. What do your customers have in common? (Get creative here. Do they like the same music? Do they share a political view? Do they have an experience that they’ve all shared?)**
- 4. If you had to sum up the “story” of your ideal customer’s life - as they tell it - how would it go?**
- 5. What would be an ideal NAME for your customer? What name epitomizes your customer?**
- 6. What’s a day in the life of your ideal customer like? Narrate it, from their perspective:**